



File No: EXP202300436

RESOLUTION OF RIGHTS PROCEDURE

Having carried out the procedural actions provided for in Title VIII of Organic Law 3/2018, of December 5, on the Protection of Personal Data and Guarantee of Digital Rights (hereinafter LOPDGDD), the following FACTS have been established:

FIRST: Mr. A.A.A. (hereinafter, the claimant) exercised the right to erasure against SAINT-GOBAIN ESPAÑA S.L. (hereinafter, the respondent) without receiving the legally established response to his request.

The claimant states that on August 31, 2022, he sent an email to the email address listed in the Privacy Policy of the respondent, comunicacionespana@saint-gobain.com, to exercise his right to data erasure, without having received a response after more than a month had passed since his request.

SECOND: In accordance with Article 65.4 of Organic Law 3/2018, of December 5, on the Protection of Personal Data and Guarantee of Digital Rights (hereinafter LOPDGDD), the aforementioned complaint was forwarded to the respondent for analysis and to inform this Agency within one month of the actions taken to comply with the requirements set forth in data protection regulations, without any response being received.

THIRD: The result of the transfer procedure indicated in the previous Fact did not allow for the understanding that the claimant's requests were satisfied. Consequently, on March 2, 2023, for the purposes provided for in Article 64.1 of the LOPDGDD, the Director of the Spanish Agency for the Protection of Data agreed to admit the complaint for processing.

The aforementioned agreement granted the respondent a hearing period, so that within fifteen working days, it could present the arguments it deemed appropriate, stating, in summary, that "(...) on the date when the events occurred, the email mentioned in the file was not duly responded to by mistake. However, in any case, from Solutions, the request was taken into account and the data was blocked, so that, from the request made, no communication could be carried out with the recipient."

FOURTH: After examining the document submitted by the respondent, it is forwarded to the claimant, so that, within fifteen working days, he can submit any arguments he considers appropriate, without submitting any arguments within the established period.

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LEGAL GROUNDS

I

Competence

In accordance with the powers granted to each supervisory authority by Article 58.2 of Regulation (EU) 2016/679 (General Data Protection Regulation, hereinafter GDPR), and as established in Articles 47, 48.1, and 64.1 of the LOPDGDD, the Director of the Spanish Agency for the Protection of Data is competent to initiate and resolve this procedure.

Furthermore, Article 63.2 of the LOPDGDD states that: "The procedures processed by the Spanish Agency for the Protection of Data shall be governed by the provisions of Regulation (EU) 2016/679, by this organic law, by the regulatory provisions issued in its development, and, in so far as they do not contradict them, subsidiarily by the general rules on administrative procedures."

II

Preliminary Issues

In accordance with the provisions of Article 55 of the GDPR, the Spanish Agency for the Protection of Data is competent to perform the functions assigned to it in Article 57, including the enforcement of the

Regulation and promoting awareness among data controllers and processors regarding their obligations, as well as addressing complaints filed by a data subject and investigating the reasons for them.

Correspondingly, Article 31 of the GDPR establishes the obligation of data controllers and processors to cooperate with the supervisory authority that requests it in the performance of its functions. In cases where they have appointed a data protection officer, Article 39 of the GDPR assigns this officer the function of cooperating with that authority.

In accordance with this regulation, prior to the admission for processing of the complaint that gives rise to this procedure, it was forwarded to the respondent for analysis, to respond to this Agency within one month, and to demonstrate that it had provided the claimant with the appropriate response, in the event of exercising the rights regulated in Articles 15 to 22 of the GDPR.

The result of this transfer did not allow for the understanding that the claimant's requests were satisfied. Consequently, on March 2, 2023, for the purposes provided for in Article 64.2 of the LOPDGDD, the Director of the Spanish Agency for the Protection of Data agreed to admit the complaint for processing. This admission agreement determines the opening of the present procedure for failure to respond to a request for the exercise of the rights established in Articles 15 to 22 of the GDPR, regulated in Article 64.1 of the LOPDGDD, according to which:

“1. When the procedure refers exclusively to the failure to respond to a request for the exercise of the rights established in Articles 15 to 22 of the...

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Regulation (EU) 2016/679 will begin with an admission agreement, which will be adopted in accordance with the provisions set forth in the following article.

In this case, the deadline for resolving the procedure will be six months from the date on which the agreement of admission was notified to the complainant. Once this period has elapsed, the interested party may consider their complaint accepted.

The clarification of administrative responsibilities within the framework of a sanctioning procedure is not deemed appropriate, as its exceptional nature implies that, whenever possible, preference should be given to alternative mechanisms that are supported by current regulations.

It is the exclusive competence of this Agency to assess whether there are administrative responsibilities that need to be clarified in a sanctioning procedure and, consequently, the decision regarding its initiation, with no obligation to initiate a procedure in response to any request made by a third party. Such a decision must be based on the existence of elements that justify the initiation of sanctioning activity, circumstances that do not occur in the present case, considering that with the current procedure, the guarantees and rights of the complainant are duly restored.

III

Rights of individuals regarding personal data protection

The rights of individuals regarding personal data protection are regulated in Articles 15 to 22 of the GDPR and Articles 13 to 18 of the LOPDGDD. The rights of access, rectification, deletion, opposition, the right to limit processing, and the right to data portability are contemplated.

The formal aspects related to the exercise of these rights are established in Articles 12 of the GDPR and 12 of the LOPDGDD.

Additionally, the provisions expressed in Recitals 59 and following of the GDPR are taken into account. In accordance with the provisions of these regulations, the data controller must establish formulas and mechanisms to facilitate the exercise of rights by the interested party, which will be free of charge (without prejudice to the provisions of Articles 12.5 and 15.3 of the GDPR), and is obliged to respond to requests made no later than one month, unless it can demonstrate that it is unable to identify the interested party, and to express its reasons in case it does not intend to comply with such a request. The burden of proof regarding compliance with the obligation to respond to the request for the exercise

of rights made by the affected party falls on the data controller.

The communication addressed to the interested party regarding their request must be expressed in a concise, transparent, intelligible, and easily accessible manner, using clear and simple language.

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IV

Right to deletion

Article 17 of the GDPR, which regulates the right to deletion of personal data, establishes the following:

"1. The interested party shall have the right to obtain from the data controller the deletion of personal data concerning them without undue delay, and the data controller shall be obliged to delete personal data without undue delay when one of the following circumstances applies:

- a) the personal data are no longer necessary in relation to the purposes for which they were collected or otherwise processed;
- b) the interested party withdraws consent on which the processing is based in accordance with Article 6(1)(a) or Article 9(2)(a), and this is not based on another legal ground;
- c) the interested party objects to the processing pursuant to Article 21(1), and there are no overriding legitimate grounds for the processing, or the interested party objects to the processing pursuant to Article 21(2);
- d) the personal data have been unlawfully processed;
- e) the personal data must be deleted for compliance with a legal obligation under Union or Member State law applicable to the data controller;
- f) the personal data have been collected in relation to the offer of information society services referred to in Article 8(1).

2. When the data controller has made the personal data public and is obliged, under the provisions of paragraph 1, to delete such data, the data controller, taking into account the available technology and the cost of implementation, shall take reasonable steps, including technical measures, to inform controllers who are processing the personal data of the interested party's request for deletion of any links to those personal data, or any copies or replications of the same.

3. Paragraphs 1 and 2 shall not apply when the processing is necessary:

- a) for exercising the right to freedom of expression and information;
- b) for compliance with a legal obligation requiring processing under Union or Member State law applicable to the data controller, or for the performance of a task carried out in the public interest or in the exercise of official authority vested in the controller;
- c) for reasons of public interest in the area of public health in accordance with Article 9(2)(h) and (i), and paragraph 3;
- d) for archiving purposes in the public interest, scientific or historical research purposes, or statistical purposes, in accordance with Article 89(1), insofar as the right referred to in paragraph 1 is likely to make impossible or seriously impede the achievement of the objectives of that processing, or
- e) for the establishment, exercise, or defense of legal claims."

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V

Conclusion

During the processing of this procedure, the entity being claimed has responded to this Agency, but it does not prove that it has addressed the request made by the claimant, sending the required response

to their request, as established by Article 12.4 of the LOPDGDD.

Thus, it cannot be accepted that the response that corresponds to be given can be manifested on the occasion of a mere administrative procedure, such as the formulation of allegations due to the present procedure, initiated precisely for not properly addressing the request in question.

The aforementioned rules do not allow for the request to be overlooked as if it had not been raised, leaving it without the response that the responsible parties must issue, even in the event that there are no data in the files or even in those cases where it does not meet the required criteria, in which case the recipient of such a request is also obliged to require the correction of the observed deficiencies or, if applicable, to deny the request with justification indicating the reasons why the right in question cannot be considered.

Therefore, the request made obliges the responsible party to provide an express response in all cases, using any means that justifies the receipt of the response.

Given that a copy of the necessary communication that must be directed to the claimant informing them about the decision made regarding the exercise of rights request is not attached, it is appropriate to uphold the claim that originated this procedure.

In view of the cited provisions and other generally applicable regulations, the Director of the Spanish Agency for Data Protection RESOLVES:

FIRST: TO UPHOLD the claim made by Mr. A.A.A. considering that the provisions of Article 17 of the GDPR have been infringed and to urge SAINT-GOBAIN ESPAÑA S.L. with NIF B96196803, to send to the claimant, within ten working days following the notification of this resolution, a certification addressing the requested right or denying it with justification indicating the reasons why the request cannot be addressed, in accordance with what is established in the body of this resolution. The actions taken as a result of this Resolution must be communicated to this Agency within the same period.

Non-compliance with this resolution could result in the commission of an infringement of Article 83.6 of the GDPR, classified as very serious for the purposes of prescription in Article 72.1.m) of the LOPDGDD, which will be sanctioned in accordance with Article 58.2 of the GDPR.

SECOND: NOTIFY this resolution to Mr. A.A.A. and to SAINT-GOBAIN ESPAÑA S.L.

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In accordance with the provisions of Article 50 of the LOPDGDD, this Resolution will be made public once it has been notified to the interested parties.

Against this resolution, which concludes the administrative procedure in accordance with Article 48.6 of the LOPDGDD, and in accordance with the provisions of Article 123 of the LPACAP, the interested parties may optionally file a motion for reconsideration before the Director of the Spanish Agency for Data Protection within one month from the day following the notification of this resolution or directly file a contentious-administrative appeal before the Contentious-Administrative Chamber of the National Court, in accordance with the provisions of Article 25 and in section 5 of the fourth additional provision of Law 29/1998, of July 13, regulating the Contentious-Administrative Jurisdiction, within two months from the day following the notification of this act, as provided in Article 46.1 of the aforementioned Law.

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